



ADMINISTRATOR ROLE

Administrator Guide

pktLog v1.0 · Full platform access

Role Overview

The **Admin** role has complete, unrestricted access to all pktLog features. Administrators configure the platform, manage users, control ingest settings, define alert rules, and perform system maintenance. Admin accounts should be limited to personnel who require platform configuration rights.

Permission Matrix

Feature	Admin	Analyst	Viewer
View dashboard and logs	✓	✓	✓
Search and filter logs	✓	✓	Basic
Export log data (CSV/JSON)	✓	✓	✗
Acknowledge / resolve alerts	✓	✓	✗
Manage alert rules	✓	✗	✗
Create / manage users	✓	✗	✗
Configure ingest settings	✓	✗	✗
Manage collector registry	✓	✗	✗
Restart service / backup	✓	✗	✗
Upload SSL certificates	✓	✗	✗

User Management

Navigate to: **Settings** → **Users**

Creating a User

1. Click **New User** to open the creation form.
2. Enter username and email (usernames must be unique and lowercase).

- 3. Set a temporary password (user should change this on first login).
- 4. Assign a role: Admin, Analyst, or Viewer. Use least privilege.
- 5. Click **Create**. The user can log in immediately.

Disabling a User

Use the active/inactive toggle on each user's row. Disable rather than delete to preserve audit history.

Role Assignment Guide

Role	Intended For
Admin	IT administrators, platform owners
Analyst	SOC analysts, security engineers, IT operations staff
Viewer	Operations observers, management stakeholders

Ingest Configuration

Navigate to: **Settings** → **Ingest**

Setting	Default	Description
Ingest Port	8761	UDP and TCP port. Restart required after change.
UDP Enabled	On	Accept syslog over UDP
TCP Enabled	On	Accept syslog over TCP
Buffer Flush Interval	5 seconds	How often to write to ClickHouse
Buffer Max Size	10,000	Force flush at this record count
Event Retention	90 days	ClickHouse TTL for syslog_events
Journal Max Size	500 MB	Disk cap for fallback journal

⚠️ Changing the ingest port requires restarting pktLog AND reconfiguring all syslog-ng collectors. Coordinate during a maintenance window.

Collector Registry

Navigate to: **Settings** → **Collectors**

The collector registry maps sending IPs to names, sites, and groups. Enrichment is applied at normalize time to every event from registered IPs.

Adding a Collector

Click **Add Collector**, enter the sending IP, display name, site label, and optional group name.

Unknown Collectors

IPs sending syslog but not in the registry appear in the **Unknown Collectors** panel. Either register them (future events will be enriched) or dismiss them (suppresses alerts without registering).

Alert Rules

Navigate to: **Alerts** → **Rules**

Rule Type	What It Detects
severity_threshold	Events at/above a severity level exceed a count in a time window
collector_silence	A registered collector stops sending for a configured period
new_collector	An unregistered IP sends syslog for the first time
rate_spike	Event rate exceeds rolling baseline by a multiplier
keyword_match	Regex pattern appears in message field

host_pattern	Events from a host pattern exceed a threshold
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Alert lifecycle: Open → Acknowledged (analyst reviewing) → Resolved.

System Maintenance

Restart service: Settings → System → Restart Service (~5 second downtime)

Backup: Settings → System → Backup — triggers 2-revision rotating backup of SQLite and config. ClickHouse data requires separate backup.

Manual retention cleanup: Settings → Storage → Manual Cleanup — triggers immediate TTL purge in ClickHouse.

Security Hardening Checklist

- 1. **Change the default `secret_key`** in `config.yaml` before first production login
- 2. **Enable HTTPS** — upload certificate via Settings → SSL/TLS
- 3. **Restrict CORS origins** in config to your actual dashboard hostname
- 4. **Limit Admin accounts** — use Analyst or Viewer for operational staff
- 5. **Set token lifetime** to 120–240 minutes for sensitive environments
- 6. **Firewall the ingest port (8761)** — allow only your collector host IPs
- 7. **Rotate the JWT secret key** periodically to force session invalidation